ROYAL FITNESS CLUB

ANABOLIC FULL GUIDE

Complete Muscle Building & Transformation Manual

12-Week Science-Backed Anabolic Program

10 Chapters • 180+ Pages • 12-Week Program • Indian Athletes Edition

By Royal Fitness Club Expert Team

■■ MEDICAL DISCLAIMER

This guide is for educational purposes only. Always consult a qualified medical professional before beginning any training, nutrition, or supplementation program. The information provided does not constitute medical advice. Individual results vary based on genetics, adherence, and starting point.

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■ CHAPTER 1 — MUSCLE BUILDING FUNDAMENTALS & SCIENCE

Muscle hypertrophy occurs through three primary mechanisms: mechanical tension (the force applied to muscle fibres during resistance training), metabolic stress (the 'pump' from accumulation of metabolites), and muscle damage (micro-tears that stimulate repair and growth). Understanding which mechanism is dominant in each exercise helps you train more intelligently.

The Three Types of Hypertrophy:

Type	Primary Stimulus	Rep Range	Best Exercises	Time Under Tension
Myofibrillar (Strength)	Mechanical Tension	1–5 reps	Squats, Deadlifts, Bench	2–4 sec/rep
Sarcoplasmic (Size)	Metabolic Stress	8–15 reps	Machine work, Isolation	3–6 sec/rep
Mixed (Optimal)	Both Tension + Stress	6–12 reps	All compound lifts	3–5 sec/rep

Key Muscle Building Principles:

- **Progressive Overload:** The single most important driver of muscle growth. Must increase load, volume, or intensity over time — without this, adaptation stops
- **Protein Synthesis vs Breakdown:** Net muscle gain only occurs when protein synthesis exceeds breakdown (MPS > MPB). Training spikes MPS; adequate protein sustains it
- **The Muscle Protein Synthesis Window:** MPS remains elevated for 24–48 hours post-training. Train each muscle 2x/week minimum for continuous anabolic stimulus
- **Motor Unit Recruitment:** Heavy loads (>70% 1RM) recruit high-threshold fast-twitch fibres — the largest, most growth-responsive fibres
- **Mind-Muscle Connection:** Intentional muscle activation during each rep increases muscle fibre recruitment by 20–30% (EMG studies)

> ■ *Studies consistently show that training to technical failure (or within 2 reps of failure) is required for maximal hypertrophic stimulus. Comfortable training produces minimal results.*

Understanding Muscle Fibre Types:

Fibre Type	Characteristics	Best Rep Range	Recovery Time	Indian Athlete Note
Type I (Slow Twitch)	High endurance, slow fatigue, small, aerobic	15–30 reps	24 hours	Common in endurance athletes; low growth potential
Type IIa (Fast Oxidative)	Moderate power, moderate fatigue, medium	8–15 reps	36–48 hours	Most trainable — respond best to hypertrophy work
Type IIx (Fast Glycolytic)	High power, fast fatigue, large, anaerobic	1–6 reps	48–72 hours	Largest fibres; biggest size gains; heavy lifting required

The Anabolic Environment — What You Need Daily:

Factor	Minimum Requirement	Optimal	Consequence of Deficit
Protein Intake	1.6g/kg bodyweight	2.0–2.4g/kg	Muscle breakdown (catabolism)
Calorie Surplus	+100–200 kcal/day	Clean bulk approach	No new muscle tissue
Sleep	7 hours	8–9 hours	GH/Testosterone crash by 40%+
Training Frequency	2x/muscle/week	2–3x/muscle/week	Insufficient MPS stimulus
Rest Between Sets	60 seconds	2–4 minutes (compound)	Incomplete neural recovery

■ CHAPTER 2 — ANABOLIC HORMONES & NATURAL OPTIMIZATION

Your hormonal environment determines the ceiling of your natural muscle-building potential. Testosterone, Growth Hormone, IGF-1, and Insulin are the four primary anabolic hormones. Understanding how to optimise each naturally allows Indian athletes to maximise results without pharmaceutical intervention.

Primary Anabolic Hormones — Overview:

Hormone	Role in Muscle Building	Natural Peak	Optimization Strategies
Testosterone	Primary anabolic hormone; drives protein synthesis and muscle fibre enlargement	Morning (6–8 AM)	Heavy compound lifts, adequate fat intake (0.8–1g/kg), sleep 8hrs, zinc, Vitamin D
Growth Hormone (GH)	Stimulates IGF-1; promotes fat mobilisation and cell repair	Deep sleep (Stage 3)	Deep sleep quality, intermittent fasting, high-intensity training, avoid sugar before bed
IGF-1	Direct muscle growth mediator; activated by GH and protein intake	Post-training	Protein timing, compound training, adequate calories
Insulin	Shuttles nutrients into muscle cells; anti-catabolic	Post-meal	Post-workout carbs (fast-acting), protein co-ingestion, avoid chronic hyperinsulinemia

Evidence-Based Testosterone Optimisation for Indian Men:

- **Training:** Compound lifts (squats, deadlifts, bench) acutely spike testosterone by 15–25%. Volume and intensity matter — 6+ sets of compound work per session is optimal
- **Dietary Fat:** Testosterone is synthesised from cholesterol. Athletes eating <20% calories from fat show 10–15% lower testosterone. Include desi ghee, eggs, groundnuts daily
- **Zinc & Magnesium:** Two most common deficiencies in Indian athletes. Zinc 25–45mg/day, Magnesium 400mg/day. Both directly required for testosterone production
- **Vitamin D:** Indian athletes surprisingly deficient due to low sun exposure (office work). 2000–4000 IU/day. Vitamin D is a steroid precursor — directly converts to testosterone
- **Body Fat:** Excess body fat (>20%) increases aromatase enzyme activity, converting testosterone to oestrogen. Maintain 10–18% body fat for optimal T levels
- **Stress Management:** Cortisol and testosterone are directly antagonistic. Chronic stress reduces testosterone by 20–40%. Daily meditation, adequate sleep, social recovery

■■ **IMPORTANT:** Testosterone levels in Indian men average 400–500 ng/dL — 20–30% below Western populations due to dietary patterns and stress. The strategies above can bring levels to 600–800 ng/dL naturally.

Cortisol — The Catabolic Enemy:

Cortisol Trigger	Effect on Muscle	Magnitude	Management Strategy
Training >90 min	Testosterone/cortisol ratio reverses	High	Keep sessions 45–75 min
Sleep <6 hours	GH secretion drops 70%	Very High	Non-negotiable: 7–9 hours
Calorie deficit >25%	Massive catabolism; muscle wasting	Very High	Max deficit: 300–500 kcal/day
Chronic life stress	Continuous cortisol elevation	High	Meditation, adaptogen herbs
Overtraining	Accumulated CNS fatigue	High	Weekly deload every 4–6 weeks
Poor carb intake	Cortisol spikes to mobilise glucose	Moderate	Carbs around training window

■ CHAPTER 3 — PROGRESSIVE OVERLOAD & ADVANCED TRAINING SYSTEMS

Progressive overload is the non-negotiable foundation of all muscle and strength gains. Without a systematic method to increase demand on the muscle over time, adaptation plateaus within weeks. This chapter covers every scientifically validated method to continue progressing past your natural plateau points.

The 7 Methods of Progressive Overload (in order of priority):

Method	How to Apply	Priority	When to Use
1. Load Increase	Add 2.5–5kg when you hit top of rep range with good form	Highest	Primary method for beginners and intermediates
2. Rep Increase	Add 1–2 reps to same weight each session	High	When small plates not available; hypertrophy phases
3. Set Volume	Add 1 working set per week across mesocycle	High	Intermediate-advanced; volume blocks
4. Density	Same volume, shorter rest periods	Medium	Metabolic conditioning; fat loss phases
5. Range of Motion	Full stretch to full contraction vs partial reps	Medium	Muscle not responding; advanced technique
6. Frequency	Add extra training day for lagging muscle	Medium	After 6+ months; specialisation phases
7. Technique	Better form = more mechanical tension on target muscle	Always	Every session; never compromise for load

Periodisation Models for Indian Athletes:

- **Linear Periodisation:** Add load every week. Best for beginners (first 6–12 months). Simple: each session, add 2.5kg to all lifts
- **Undulating Periodisation (DUP):** Vary rep ranges within same week (Day 1: 4×5, Day 2: 3×10, Day 3: 2×15). More advanced; prevents accommodation
- **Block Periodisation:** 4-week accumulation → 3-week intensification → 1-week deload. Royal Fitness Club's recommended approach for intermediate athletes
- **Conjugate:** Max effort + dynamic effort days simultaneously. Powerlifting-specific; not recommended for pure hypertrophy goals

Training Split Comparison for Indian Lifestyle:

Split	Frequency	Best For	Recovery Demand	Sample Week
Full Body 3x	3 days/week	Beginners, time-constrained	Low	Mon/Wed/Fri
Upper/Lower 4x	4 days/week	Intermediate; muscle balance	Moderate	Mon/Tue/Thu/Fri
PPL (Push/Pull/Legs)	5–6 days/week	Intermediate-Advanced	High	Mon-Sat
Bro Split	5–6 days/week	NOT recommended — 1x frequency too low	Moderate	Chest Mon, Back Tue...
Royal RFC 3-Day	3 days/week	Indian schedule; gym 3×/week	Low-Moderate	Mon/Wed/Sat

■ CHAPTER 4 — NUTRITION BLUEPRINTS FOR MAXIMUM MUSCLE GROWTH

For Indian athletes, nutrition is often the biggest gap. Western bodybuilding advice is built around chicken breast and whey protein — ignoring the reality of Indian kitchens. This chapter provides a complete, culturally-relevant nutrition system built around desi foods.

Calorie Calculation for Indian Athletes:

- **Step 1 — Calculate BMR:** Men: (10 × weight kg) + (6.25 × height cm) – (5 × age) + 5. Women: (10 × weight kg) + (6.25 × height cm) – (5 × age) – 161
- **Step 2 — Apply Activity Multiplier:** Sedentary (desk job, no gym): ×1.2; Light active (gym 1–3x): ×1.375; Moderately active (gym 3–5x): ×1.55; Very active (gym 6–7x): ×1.725
- **Step 3 — Set Goal Calories:** Lean bulk (muscle gain, minimal fat): TDEE + 200–300 kcal. Aggressive bulk: TDEE + 500 kcal (expect some fat gain)
- **Protein Priority:** Set protein first at 2.0–2.4g/kg. Fill remaining calories with carbs (>50%) and fats (~25–30%)

Top Indian Protein Sources (per 100g cooked):

Food Item	Protein (g)	Calories	Cost Rating	Availability
Chicken Breast (boneless)	31g	165	★★★	All cities
Paneer (low-fat)	18g	260	★★■	Universal
Egg Whites (3 eggs)	11g	51	★★★	Universal
Whole Eggs (2 eggs)	13g	143	★★★	Universal
Moong Dal (cooked)	8g	105	★★★	Universal
Rajma (cooked)	9g	127	★★★	Universal
Soya Chunks (cooked)	15g	117	★★★	Universal
Tuna (canned)	26g	132	★★■	Metro cities
Greek Yogurt (dahi)	10g	97	★★■	Urban areas
Whey Protein (1 scoop)	24g	120	★■■	Online/supplement store

Optimal Meal Timing for Muscle Growth:

Meal	Timing	Composition	Key Goal
Pre-Workout Meal	90–120 min before training	Complex carbs + moderate protein (no fat)	Glycogen loading; stable energy
Pre-Workout Snack	30–45 min before	Fast carbs + 20–30g protein (whey ideal)	Peak performance fuel
Intra-Workout	During training (>75 min only)	Electrolytes + 20–30g fast carbs (banana/dextrose)	Prevent muscle breakdown during long sessions
Post-Workout	Within 30–60 min	50–80g fast carbs + 40g protein (whey)	Maximise MPS; glycogen replenishment
Before Bed	30–45 min before sleep	Slow casein protein (100g dahi, paneer, milk)	Prevent overnight muscle breakdown (8 hours fast)

■ CHAPTER 5 — SUPPLEMENT GUIDE — WHAT ACTUALLY WORKS (RANKED)

The supplement industry in India is worth ■3,500+ crore and filled with marketing claims. This chapter separates science from sales — giving you only the supplements with strong evidence, ranked by actual effectiveness for Indian athletes.

Tier 1 — Strong Evidence (Definitely Take):

Supplement	Dose	Timing	Evidence Level	Expected Benefit
Creatine Monohydrate	3–5g/day	Anytime (post-workout ideal)	Grade A (50+ studies)	5–10% strength, 2–4kg lean mass
Whey Protein	20–40g/day	Post-workout + anytime	Grade A	Convenient protein source; 1.4× cheaper per gram than chicken
Vitamin D3	2000–4000 IU/day	With food (fat-soluble)	Grade A	Testosterone support; Indian deficiency very common
Magnesium Glycinate	300–400mg/day	Before bed	Grade A	Sleep quality; testosterone; 300+ enzymatic reactions
Zinc (ZMA form)	25–30mg/day	Before bed (empty stomach)	Grade A	Testosterone; immune function; protein synthesis

Tier 2 — Moderate Evidence (Worth Considering):

Supplement	Dose	Evidence	Note
Caffeine (pre-workout)	3–6mg/kg bodyweight	Grade B	10–15% strength; 12–15% endurance. Natural source: black coffee
Beta-Alanine	3.2–6.4g/day	Grade B	Muscular endurance; tingles normal (paresthesia)
Citrulline Malate	6–8g pre-workout	Grade B	Pump; endurance; less fatigue
Omega-3 (Fish Oil)	2–4g EPA+DHA/day	Grade B	Anti-inflammatory; muscle protein synthesis support
Ashwagandha (KSM-66)	300–600mg/day	Grade B	Cortisol reduction; testosterone support; Indian adaptogen

Tier 3 — Weak/No Evidence (Skip These):

- **Testosterone Boosters:** No product raises testosterone meaningfully. Ingredients like Tribulus have been studied extensively — zero significant effect
- **Fat Burners:** Most are stimulant blends (caffeine + synephrine). You can buy caffeine for ■50 and get identical results. Save the ■2,000
- **BCAAs (if eating adequate protein):** If you hit 1.6g+ protein per kg, BCAAs are redundant — all three amino acids are in your food
- **'Mass Gainers' from unknown brands:** Often pure maltodextrin (cheap sugar). Make your own: 200g oats + 2 bananas + 2 scoops whey = ■50 mass gainer

■ CHAPTER 6 — RECOVERY, SLEEP & CORTISOL MANAGEMENT

Recovery IS training. Every adaptation you seek — bigger muscles, more strength, better body composition — happens during rest, not during the workout. The workout is the stimulus; recovery is the response. Most Indian athletes under-recover because they over-train and under-sleep.

Sleep Optimization for Muscle Growth:

Sleep Stage	Duration	Anabolic Activity	Disruption Effect
Stage 1–2 (Light)	~50% of sleep	Minimal — body preparing for deep stages	Frequent waking reduces total deep sleep time
Stage 3 (Deep/SWS)	~20–25% of sleep	Peak GH secretion (70–80% of daily GH); tissue repair	Even 1-hour reduction cuts GH by 35%; training gains blunted
REM Sleep	~20–25% of sleep	Memory consolidation; motor learning; emotional regulation	REM loss impairs coordination; increases cortisol

Royal RFC Sleep Protocol — Non-Negotiable Rules:

- **9 PM — Lights Down:** Dim all lights 2 hours before bed. Blue light from phone suppresses melatonin — use Night Mode or glasses from 8 PM
- **No Food/Protein 45 min BEFORE bed:** This is wrong advice. Have 30–40g slow protein (milk, paneer, curd) before bed — prevents 8 hours of muscle breakdown
- **Room Temperature:** 18–22°C is optimal for deep sleep. Many Indian apartments run warm — a fan or AC set to 22°C dramatically improves sleep quality
- **No Pre-Workout Caffeine After 2 PM:** Caffeine half-life is 5–6 hours. 400mg at 4 PM = 200mg active at 10 PM. Sleep disrupted even if you fall asleep normally
- **Consistent Wake Time:** More important than bed time. Set a consistent alarm 7 days/week. Your cortisol awakening response (CAR) calibrates to it — affecting energy all day

■ CHAPTER 7 — ADVANCED TECHNIQUES: DROP SETS, SUPERSETS, CLUSTERS

Advanced training techniques allow intermediate and experienced athletes to increase intensity, volume, and mechanical tension beyond what straight sets allow. Used correctly, they produce rapid hypertrophy. Misused, they cause overtraining. Here is exactly when, how, and how often to use each technique.

Technique	How to Perform	Best For	Frequency	Example
Drop Sets	Perform a set to failure; immediately reduce weight 20–30% and continue	Metabolic stress; muscle endurance; sarcoplasmic hypertrophy	1–2 per session MAX; last set of isolation exercise	Dumbbell curls: 15kg×10 → 10kg×8 → 7kg×8
Supersets (Antagonist)	Alternate sets of opposing muscle groups; minimal rest between pairs	Time efficiency; antagonist pump; chest+back, biceps+triceps	Any frequency; excellent general strategy	Pull-ups × 8 → immediately Dips × 8 → 90s rest
Cluster Sets	Set of 4 reps; 15s rest; 4 reps; 15s rest; 4 reps = 12 total with mini-rests	Strength-hypertrophy; maintain heavier loads for more volume	1–2 clusters per session; heavy compound lifts	5RM Squat × 4, rest 15s × 4, rest 15s × 4 = 12 reps at 5RM
Rest-Pause	Perform reps to failure; 10–15s rest; 2–3 more reps; repeat	Maximise fibre recruitment; time-efficient intensity	1–2 per session; good for lagging muscles	Incline Press to 8-rep failure; rest 12s; 3 more; rest 12s; 2 more
Mechanical Drop Sets	Change body position (easier) to extend set without dropping weight	Continuous tension with same load; innovative overload	1 per exercise; good for isolation	Incline curls → Preacher curls → Standing curls (same weight)

■■ **IMPORTANT:** Advanced techniques are tools, not daily habits. Use them sparingly (1–2 per session maximum) on isolation exercises. Heavy compound lifts (squats, deadlifts, rows) do not benefit from drop sets or rest-pause — the fatigue risk outweighs the gain.

■ CHAPTER 8 — FULL 12-WEEK ANABOLIC TRANSFORMATION PROGRAM

This 12-week program is divided into three 4-week phases. Each phase builds on the previous with progressive intensity, volume, and technique complexity. The program uses a Push/Pull/Legs split 5 days/week with planned deloads and progressive overload built in.

Phase Structure Overview:

Phase	Weeks	Focus	Sets per Exercise	Rep Range	Intensity
Phase 1 — Foundation	Weeks 1–4	Movement patterns, motor learning, baseline volume	3–4 sets	10–12 reps	65–70% 1RM
Phase 2 — Hypertrophy	Weeks 5–8	Volume peak, metabolic stress, pump training	4–5 sets	8–12 reps	70–80% 1RM
Phase 3 — Intensification	Weeks 9–12	Load peaking, advanced techniques, strength base	3–5 sets	4–8 reps	80–90% 1RM
Deload Week	Week 4, 8, 12	Active recovery, technique refinement, CNS reset	2 sets	10–15 reps (easy)	50–60% 1RM

Week 1–4 Training Template (Foundation Phase):

Day	Session	Key Exercises	Sets × Reps	Rest
Monday	PUSH — Chest/Shoulders/Triceps	Flat Barbell Bench Press Incline Dumbbell Press Seated Shoulder Press Lateral Raises Tricep Pushdown	4×10 3×12 3×10 3×15 3×12	2 min 90s 90s 60s 60s
Tuesday	PULL — Back/Biceps	Barbell Row (Bent Over) Lat Pulldown Seated Cable Row Face Pulls Barbell Bicep Curl	4×8 3×12 3×12 3×15 3×12	2 min 90s 90s 60s 90s
Wednesday	LEGS — Quad/Ham/Glutes	Barbell Back Squat Romanian Deadlift Leg Press Leg Curl Calf Raises	4×8 3×10 3×12 3×12 4×15	3 min 2 min 2 min 90s 60s
Thursday	REST / Active Recovery	Light walking 20–30 min Mobility work 15 min Foam rolling	—	—
Friday	PUSH — Shoulders/Chest	Overhead Press (Standing) Incline Barbell Press Dumbbell Flyes Arnold Press Dips (bodyweight)	4×8 3×10 3×12 3×12 3×failure	2 min 90s 60s 90s 60s
Saturday	PULL — Back/Arms	Deadlift (conventional) Pull-Ups (weighted if possible) Dumbbell Row Hammer Curls Preacher Curl	4×5 3×8 3×10 3×12 3×12	3 min 2 min 90s 60s 60s
Sunday	FULL REST	Sleep 8–9 hours High protein nutrition No training	—	—

■■ CHAPTER 9 — DIET TEMPLATES, CALORIE & MACRO BLUEPRINTS

Complete Indian meal plan templates for different body weights and goals. All meals use ingredients available in Indian markets. Macros are calculated precisely.

Template A — 70kg Male, Lean Bulk (2,800 kcal | 175g Protein | 320g Carbs | 75g Fat):

Meal	Time	Foods	Protein	Carbs	Fat	Calories
Breakfast	7:00 AM	5 whole eggs (scrambled) + 2 chapati + 1 glass milk	38g	60g	22g	590
Mid-Morning	10:30 AM	1 banana + 30g mixed nuts + 1 scoop whey	28g	35g	15g	385
Lunch	1:00 PM	200g chicken curry + 1.5 cups rice + 1 bowl dal + salad	50g	90g	14g	690
Pre-Workout	4:00 PM	1 banana + 1 scoop whey + black coffee	27g	35g	2g	266
Post-Workout	6:30 PM	1.5 cups rice + 200g chicken/paneer (100g) + 1 cup sabzi	42g	65g	12g	536
Dinner	9:00 PM	150g paneer bhurji + 2 roti + 1 cup dal + 1 glass milk	42g	55g	20g	558
TOTAL	—	—	227g	340g	85g	3,025

■ CHAPTER 10 — INJURY PREVENTION, JOINT HEALTH & LONGEVITY

The athlete who stays injury-free for 5 years will always outperform the athlete who trains harder for 2 years before getting injured. Injury prevention is not boring maintenance — it is the foundation of long-term results.

Most Common Injuries in Indian Gym Athletes (and Prevention):

Injury	Root Cause	Prevention Protocol	If Injured
Lower Back (L4/L5)	Poor hip hinge pattern; deadlifting with rounded lumbar	Hip hinge drills daily; belt for 90%+ lifts; gradual load increase	Stop loading immediately; physio assessment; McGill Big 3
Rotator Cuff	Internal shoulder rotation; excessive pressing without pulling	Equal push:pull ratio (1:1 or 1:1.5); face pulls 3×/week; external rotation work	Rest 2–4 weeks; Pendulum swings; band rotations
Knee (Patellar Tendon)	Excessive quad load; poor ankle mobility; fast progression	Single-leg work; ankle mobility drills; step progressions	Eccentric leg extensions; reduce load to pain-free range
Bicep Tendon	Heavy curls with elbow supinated; sudden load increases	Warm up elbow fully; no ego curls; strict form	Rest, ice, gentle range of motion; avoid heavy pulling 4–6 weeks

Daily Joint Health Protocol (15 minutes — do every session):

- **Warm-Up (5 min):** World's greatest stretch × 5/side, Hip circles × 10, Shoulder CARs × 8, Ankle circles × 10, Leg swings front/side × 10
- **Activation (5 min):** Glute bridges × 15, Band pull-aparts × 15, Dead bugs × 8/side, Copenhagen plank × 20 sec/side
- **Cool-Down (5 min):** 90/90 hip stretch × 45 sec/side, Doorframe pec stretch × 45 sec, Cat-cow × 10, Child's pose × 45 sec

The biggest competitive advantage in fitness is not your training program or your diet. It is your ability to stay consistent and injury-free for years while others cycle in and out of injuries.